



To: All Arizona referees From: Joel Votaw, State Referee Administrator

Hear it. Act. Every time.

Our updated Discriminatory & Harmful Language Policy, a 5-minute video, and a 10-minute practice run.

Hi **everyone**, our fields should be safe from discriminatory language for everyone on them: players, coaches, fans, and you. How we respond in that moment matters more than almost any call we make all season. The one-page policy is attached; here's the short version.

TWO RULES. NO EXCEPTIONS.

We NEVER ignore it if we hear it.
We NEVER ignore an allegation.

"I didn't hear it, so there's nothing I can do" is never the answer.



Heard it Red card

Any match official heard or saw it. **Zero tolerance, every time.** Tell that team's coach why, restart, and report it.



Told about it Stop and address it

Stop play and listen. Send both teams to their benches and ask your crew. **If no one heard it, no card.** Meet both coaches together at midfield, give them 1-2 minutes with their teams, then restart and report it.



Spectator Stop, remove, report

Stop play. Have the coach or field marshal remove the person. Don't restart until they're gone. Report it.

WHAT'S CHANGED

- Allegations are handled with both coaches, together, at midfield.** Both teams go to their benches. Tell the coaches what was alleged, that no one on the crew heard it so no sanction can be given, that it will be reported, and that further allegations may lead to abandonment.
- We only card what a match official heard or saw**, even if the player admits it afterwards. The admission goes in the report word for word.
- No one is ever made to apologize**, and we never bring the players together.

REPORTING redcards.azref.com within 8 hours of kickoff. Choose "Discriminatory or harmful language / conduct." Exact words in quotes, facts only.

✓ Your two action items

By October 15, 2026

1 Watch the 5-minute training video



youtu.be/5SLDODv0NuU

2 Run the Practice Report



Tap **Practice: Discriminatory Language Report**, then **Record My Practice** at the end to get your training verified. About 10 minutes; nothing is sent to any league.

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